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UI/UX DESIGN COMPARISON

# WaitLess

## Screen-by-Screen Interface & User Experience Analysis

**Systems Analysed**

WaitLess • ScanQueue • Qminder • Waitwhile • Qmatic • Wavetec • Keona

**Evaluation Areas**

Visual design • Layout patterns • Patient-facing screens • Staff dashboards
Navigation • Mobile experience • Accessibility • Animation & micro-interactions

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# 1. Evaluation Methodology

Each system was evaluated across 8 UI/UX dimensions, scored from 1 to 5 stars. The evaluation is based on published product screenshots, documentation, user reviews, feature descriptions, and product update announcements as of August 2026.

| Dimension | What we evaluated |
|---|---|
| **Visual Design** | Color palette, typography, spacing, use of whitespace, modern aesthetic, visual hierarchy |
| **Layout & Information Architecture** | Screen organization, navigation patterns, content grouping, dashboard density |
| **Patient-Facing Screens** | Registration flow, tracking page, queue board, mobile experience, clarity for non-technical users |
| **Staff Dashboard** | Queue management view, action buttons, data density, filtering, real-time updates |
| **Mobile Experience** | Responsive design, touch targets, mobile-specific layouts, PWA support |
| **Accessibility & i18n** | WCAG compliance, screen reader support, multi-language, right-to-left support |
| **Animation & Micro-interactions** | Loading states, transitions, hover effects, progress indicators, empty states |
| **Onboarding & Empty States** | First-run experience, empty state guidance, error states, form validation feedback |

# 2. Overall UI/UX Scorecard

| Dimension | WaitLess | ScanQueue | Qminder | Waitwhile | Qmatic | Wavetec |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Visual Design** | ★★★★★ | ★★★★☆ | ★★★★☆ | ★★★★★ | ★★★☆☆ | ★★☆☆☆ |
| **Layout & IA** | ★★★★☆ | ★★★★☆ | ★★★★☆ | ★★★★★ | ★★★☆☆ | ★★★☆☆ |
| **Patient Screens** | ★★★★★ | ★★★★☆ | ★★★☆☆ | ★★★★☆ | ★★☆☆☆ | ★★☆☆☆ |
| **Staff Dashboard** | ★★★★★ | ★★★★☆ | ★★★★☆ | ★★★★☆ | ★★★☆☆ | ★★★☆☆ |
| **Mobile Experience** | ★★★★★ | ★★★★☆ | ★★★★☆ | ★★★★★ | ★★☆☆☆ | ★★☆☆☆ |
| **Accessibility & i18n** | ★★★★☆ | ★★☆☆☆ | ★★★☆☆ | ★★★☆☆ | ★★★★☆ | ★★★☆☆ |
| **Animation & Micro** | ★★★★★ | ★★★☆☆ | ★★★☆☆ | ★★★★☆ | ★★☆☆☆ | ★★☆☆☆ |
| **Onboarding** | ★★★★☆ | ★★★★★ | ★★★★☆ | ★★★★★ | ★★★☆☆ | ★★☆☆☆ |
| **UI/UX TOTAL** | ★★★★½ | ★★★★☆ | ★★★½☆ | ★★★★½ | ★★★☆☆ | ★★½☆☆ |

**Key takeaway:** WaitLess and Waitwhile tie for the highest UI/UX score (4.5/5). Waitwhile wins on simplicity and onboarding. WaitLess wins on visual polish, animation, patient-facing screens, and staff dashboard depth. ScanQueue is close behind (4.0/5) with a clean modern approach. Qmatic and Wavetec lag significantly due to enterprise/legacy UI patterns.

# 3. Screen-by-Screen Comparison

## A. Patient Registration / Check-In Screen

### WaitLess

**WaitLess — Registration (Staff Desk)**

- Search Bar — Search by name, phone, national ID, QR scan
- Form — Full demographics, category badges, next of kin, chief complaint
- QR Code — Generated ticket with QR, printed 80mm or shared to phone
- Auto-save — Form draft recovery — never lose data on crash
- Consent — WhatsApp notification consent checkbox with clear language

**Design strengths:** Glassmorphism panel with gradient background, Lottie animations on AuthShell, profile completeness meter, profile photo picker with initials fallback, patient category badges with color coding, form auto-save indicator. Three registration channels (staff desk, self-registration, kiosk) each with tailored UI.

### ScanQueue

**ScanQueue — QR Check-In (Patient Phone)**

- QR Scan — Patient scans QR code → opens browser → joins queue
- Join Form — Customizable fields (name, party size, phone, notes)
- Benefits — "SMS updates, real-time tracking, skip physical wait"

**Design strengths:** Extremely simple — 15 seconds to join. No app download. Clean mobile-first form.
**Design weaknesses:** No staff desk registration UI for complex patient data capture. No demographics, no national ID, no next of kin, no chief complaint — too simple for hospital use.

### Qmatic

**Qmatic — Kiosk Check-In**

- Kiosk — Physical kiosk hardware with touch screen
- Ticket — Printed paper ticket from kiosk printer
- Mobile — Mobile Ticket via app or SMS link

**Design strengths:** Purpose-built kiosk UI is large-touch-target optimized. Surface Editor allows custom layout design for kiosks and displays. **Design weaknesses:** Requires hardware investment. Kiosk UI is dated. No web self-registration. Mobile ticket is basic — no rich tracking page.

### Waitwhile

**Waitwhile — Customer Join Flow**

| | |
|---|---|
| QR/Web | Scan QR or visit link → join waitlist |
| Form | Name, party size, phone, notes — button-based (not dropdowns) |
| Card/List | Services shown as square icons or cards, not dots |

**Design strengths:** Ranked #1 easiest-to-use by G2. Button-based service selection (reduces clicks). Card or list layout toggle. Drag-and-drop waitlist management. Clean, consumer-grade aesthetic. **Design weaknesses:** No clinical data capture. No triage. No national ID. Not hospital-grade.

### Registration Winner: WaitLess

WaitLess is the only system that offers three registration channels (staff desk, self-registration, kiosk) with rich clinical data capture (demographics, next of kin, chief complaint, patient categories, WhatsApp consent). The glassmorphism design with Lottie animations and profile completeness meter creates a welcoming experience. ScanQueue and Waitwhile are simpler but lack clinical depth. Qmatic requires hardware.

## B. Patient Tracking / Queue Status Screen

### WaitLess

**WaitLess — Track Page (/track)**

- Ticket Input — Enter ticket code (e.g., OPD-205) or scan QR
- Position — Live queue position with patient count ahead
- ETA — AI-powered estimated wait time
- Timeline — Progress: Registered → Triage → Waiting → Called → Served
- Directions — "Proceed to Room 3, OPD wing"
- History — Notification history (WhatsApp messages sent)
- Real-time — SSE updates — no page refresh needed

**Design strengths:** Rich timeline with 5 stages, real-time SSE updates, AI-powered ETA, notification history, department directions. Works on any phone browser. Multi-language support (EN/Shona/Ndebele). PWA with offline caching.

### ScanQueue

**ScanQueue — Queue Status Page (/queue/{ticket-id})**

- Position Circle — Large circle showing position (#1, #2, etc.)
- Status — "You're #X in line" or "It's your turn!"
- ETA — Minutes until turn (hidden when next)
- Progress — 3-step: Joined → Waiting → Being Called
- Leave — "Leave Queue" button with confirmation

**Design strengths:** Large position circle is visually clear. Pulsing green circle when called is a great micro-interaction. 3-step progress is simple and intuitive. Leave queue button is accessible. **Design weaknesses:** Only 3 stages (vs WaitLess's 5). No notification history. No department directions. No multi-language. No timeline of what happened at each stage.

### Qminder

**Qminder — TV Display**

- TV Screen — Shows called visitor name + desk number

Waiting Shows waiting list on TV

**Design strengths:** Clean TV display. Called visitor name shown prominently with desk number. **Design weaknesses:** No patient-facing phone tracking page. No position indicator. No ETA. No progress timeline. Patient must watch the TV or wait for SMS.

### Tracking Winner: WaitLess

WaitLess offers the richest tracking experience: 5-stage timeline, AI-powered ETA, notification history, department directions, real-time SSE updates, and multi-language support. ScanQueue's position circle and pulsing animation is a nice touch but lacks depth. Qmatic and Qminder have no patient phone tracking at all.

## C. Staff Dashboard / Queue Management

### WaitLess

**WaitLess — Staff Dashboard (/admin/dashboard)**

- Metrics — Total waiting, in service, transferred, completed today
- Priority — Color-coded queue (Red/Yellow/Green/Black rows)
- Actions — Call Next, Mark Missed, Recall, Transfer, Complete — inline buttons
- Alerts — Reassessment alerts for long-waiting Red/Yellow patients
- Bottleneck — AI bottleneck alerts per department
- Notifications — WhatsApp delivery status panel
- Charts — Recharts: queue trends, department load, priority distribution
- Filter — Department filter, status filter, search

**Design strengths:** Most comprehensive dashboard of any system. Priority color-coding in queue rows gives instant visual triage awareness. Reassessment alerts are unique — no competitor has them. AI bottleneck alerts with severity levels. Recharts integration for analytics. Inline action buttons reduce clicks. Dark mode support. Sidebar navigation with role-based menu items.

### ScanQueue

**ScanQueue — Dashboard (/dashboard)**

- Stats — Total waiting, being served, avg wait, est. wait for next
- Serving — Currently Serving panel: Mark Served, No Show, Return to Queue
- Next — Next Up panel with "Call Next" button
- Waiting — Grid of all waiting with action menu (Move Up/Down, Move to Front, Remove)
- Delay — Queue delay control (add/remove 5-min increments)
- Connection — Live/Synced/Connecting status indicator

**Design strengths:** Clean tabbed layout (Waitlist, Reports, Billing). Connection status indicator is a nice touch. Queue delay control is unique — lets staff add buffer time. Move to Front for VIPs. Multi-counter mode with service tabs and counter cards. **Design weaknesses:** No priority color-coding. No triage acuity display. No reassessment alerts. No AI insights. No notification delivery panel. No charts/analytics on the main dashboard.

### Qminder

**Qminder — Service View**

| | |
|---|---|
| Left Panel | Ticket list with visitor names, wait times, labels |
| Center | Large green "CALL NEXT" text/button |
| Right | Visitor details panel (full height, left-aligned fields) |
| Top | Line and desk selection (multi-select with search) |
| Actions | Call Visitor, Finish Serving, Call Next, Remove, Return to Queue |
| Completed | Served / No-shows / Removed sections |

**Design strengths:** Recently redesigned with clean, organized UI. Full-height detail view uses screen space well. Multi-selection of lines and labels (added after user feedback). Three-dots menu for additional actions keeps the UI clean. Overview page with ticket cards is visually appealing. **Design weaknesses:** No priority color-coding for triage. No AI insights. No notification panel. No charts on main view. No dark mode. No multi-language.

### Waitwhile

**Waitwhile — Waitlist Board View**

| | |
|---|---|
| Drag & Drop | Drag visits up/down in board view on all devices |
| Buttons | Services/resources as buttons (not dropdowns) — reduces clicks |
| Icons | Square icons/initials for services (was colored dots) |
| Status | Color-coded: Available (green), Busy (red), Away (yellow) |
| Quick Serve | Quick serve widget for fast visit completion |
| Filter | Filter by label or service via URL params |

**Design strengths:** G2 #1 easiest-to-use. Drag-and-drop is the best queue reordering UX of any system. Button-based workflows reduce cognitive load. Square service icons are more visually distinct than dots. Quick serve widget speeds up high-volume operations. Status color-coding is clear. **Design weaknesses:** No clinical features. No triage. No priority levels. No AI. No notification panel. No analytics on main view. Not hospital-grade.

### Qmatic Orchestra 7

**Qmatic — Operations Panel**

| | |
|---|---|
| Real-time | Operations panel with branch/counter overview |
| BI | Business Intelligence dashboard designer (canned + custom reports) |
| Config | Branch configuration UI (redesigned in 7.4) |

| | |
|---|---|
| Surface | Surface Editor for kiosk/display layouts |

**Design strengths:** Branch config redesigned in 7.4 with filter/search/scheduling. BI dashboard designer is powerful for data analysts. Surface Editor is unique — design kiosk/display layouts visually. **Design weaknesses:** Enterprise/legacy feel. Dense UI with many tabs and sub-menus. Counter staff UI is functional but not modern. No patient-facing web UI. No dark mode. No animations. Feels like a 2010s enterprise application.

### Wavetec Spectra

**Wavetec — Spectra Dashboard**

| | |
|---|---|
| Map | Branch map view (satellite option) with good/neutral/bad indicators |
| Hardware | Hardware monitoring dashboard (kiosks, displays status) |
| Reports | 50+ historical reports with charts (bar, linear) |
| Export | Print charts, download as images/PDFs/vector |

**Design strengths:** Map view with satellite option is visually impressive. Hardware monitoring is unique (for hardware-based systems). 50+ report types is the most comprehensive reporting. **Design weaknesses:** Most dated UI of all systems compared. Feels like a 2000s desktop application ported to web. No modern design patterns (no cards, no glassmorphism, no gradients). No patient-facing UI. No dark mode. No animations. No mobile-responsive design. Charts are basic.

### Staff Dashboard Winner: WaitLess

WaitLess has the most comprehensive and visually polished staff dashboard. Priority color-coding, reassessment alerts, AI bottleneck alerts, notification delivery panel, and Recharts analytics are features no competitor offers in a single view. Waitwhile wins on interaction design (drag-and-drop) but lacks clinical depth. ScanQueue is clean but too simple for hospital use. Qmatic and Wavetec feel like legacy enterprise applications.

## D. Public Queue Board / Display Screen

### WaitLess

**WaitLess — Public Queue Board (/queue)**

- Now Serving — OPD-203 (green highlight, large text)
- Next — OPD-204, OPD-205, OPD-206 (muted text)
- Missed — OPD-199 (red text, "see reception")
- Privacy — Ticket numbers only — no patient names
- Real-time — SSE updates — instant, no refresh
- Dept Board — Separate per-department board (/department-board)

**Design strengths:** Three-lane layout (Now Serving / Waiting / Missed) is clear. Real-time SSE updates. Privacy-first (ticket numbers only). Department-specific boards. QR code on board for patients to scan and track on phone. Hospital branding.

### ScanQueue

**ScanQueue — Public Board**

- Cast — Dashboard cast to any existing TV
- Privacy — Ticket numbers instead of names
- Configurable — Retention — purge data at end of clinical day

**Design strengths:** Simple — cast dashboard to any TV. Configurable data retention for privacy. **Design weaknesses:** "Waiting room display is basic compared to purpose-built options" (per WaitWell review). No dedicated board UI — just casts the staff dashboard. No three-lane layout. No missed lane.

### Qmatic

**Qmatic — Waiting Area Display**

- Hardware — Purpose-built display hardware (Donatello)
- Surface Editor — Design custom layouts for displays
- Signage — Digital signage with marketing/health content
- Audio — Voice announcements via overhead speakers

**Design strengths:** Surface Editor allows custom display layouts — unique feature. Digital signage content management (health education, announcements) reduces perceived wait time. Purpose-built hardware ensures reliability. Audio announcements via dedicated speakers. **Design weaknesses:** Requires hardware investment. Display UI is dated. No web-based board. No real-time web updates (relies on hardware polling).

### Queue Board Winner: WaitLess (tied with Qmatic for different reasons)

WaitLess wins for software-based boards: real-time SSE, three-lane layout, privacy-first, department-specific boards, QR scan-to-track. Qmatic wins for hardware-based displays: Surface Editor for custom layouts and digital signage content management. WaitLess could improve by adding a content carousel for health education messages between queue updates (a Qmatic/Wavetec feature).

# 4. Design Pattern Comparison

## Navigation Patterns

| System | Navigation approach | Effectiveness |
|---|---|---|
| **WaitLess** | Sidebar navigation with role-based menu items. Collapsible. Icons + labels. Breadcrumbs in sub-pages. | ★★★★☆ — Clear, role-aware. Could benefit from breadcrumbs on all pages. |
| **ScanQueue** | Top tabs: Waitlist, Reports, Billing. Simple and flat. | ★★★★☆ — Very simple. Works well for their limited feature set. |
| **Qminder** | Top-left logo → Overview. Left panel = ticket list. Center = actions. Right = details. | ★★★★☆ — Clean three-panel layout. Recently redesigned. |
| **Waitwhile** | Left sidebar with sections. Board view with drag-and-drop. Side panels for details. | ★★★★★ — Best navigation. Drag-and-drop is intuitive. Side panels don't lose context. |
| **Qmatic** | Multi-level tabs and sub-menus. Many configuration sections. | ★★★☆☆ — Complex. Requires training. Too many levels. |
| **Wavetec** | Desktop-application style menu bars and toolbars. | ★★☆☆☆ — Feels like a 2000s desktop app. Not web-native. |

## Color & Visual Language

| System | Color approach | Visual style |
|---|---|---|
| **WaitLess** | CSS variables for theming. Priority colors (Red/Yellow/Green/Black). Gradient primary. Dark mode. Glassmorphism. | Modern, polished, welcoming. Best use of color for clinical triage awareness. |
| **ScanQueue** | Clean, minimal. Blue/green accent. White background. Position circle color changes by status. | Clean and modern but minimal. Lacks visual richness. |
| **Waitwhile** | Color-coded statuses (green/red/yellow). Square service icons with colors. Consumer-grade palette. | Beautiful, consumer-grade. Best for retail. Too casual for clinical use. |
| **Qmatic** | Corporate blue/grey. Standard enterprise palette. | Functional, dated. No visual distinction. |
| **Wavetec** | Basic charts with limited color options. Map view with traffic-light colors. | Most dated. Feels like old Windows software. |

## Animation & Micro-interactions

| System | Animations | Loading states |
|---|---|---|
| **WaitLess** | Lottie animations on AuthShell, animated ribbons, gradient transitions, hover effects, icon animations, glassmorphism blur effects, LoadingPanel with branded loader. | Custom LoadingPanel with branded spinner. Suspense fallback for lazy-loaded routes. Sonner toasts for feedback. |
| **ScanQueue** | Pulsing green circle when called. Connection status indicator (Live/Synced/Connecting). | Basic. "Typing..." indicator in chatbot. |
| **Waitwhile** | Drag-and-drop animations. Smooth transitions. Button hover states. | Skeleton loaders. Progress indicators. |
| **Qmatic** | Minimal. Standard page loads. | Standard spinner. No branded loader. |
| **Wavetec** | None noticeable. | Basic. No loading states described. |

# 5. UI/UX Gaps & Recommendations

Based on the screen-by-screen analysis, here are the UI/UX improvements that would close gaps with competitors:

### 1. Drag-and-Drop Queue Reordering (from Waitwhile)

Waitwhile's drag-and-drop board view is the best queue reordering UX. WaitLess currently uses inline buttons (Move Up/Down). Adding drag-and-drop would make queue management more intuitive.

> **Recommendation:** Add drag-and-drop to the staff dashboard queue table using a library like @dnd-kit/core. Allow staff to drag patients up/down to reorder, with a visual drop indicator.

### 2. Content Carousel on Queue Board (from Qmatic/Wavetec)

Qmatic and Wavetec display health education content, facility announcements, and directional information on waiting area displays alongside queue data. This reduces perceived wait time by 35% (Wavetec data).

> **Recommendation:** Add a content carousel to the public queue board that rotates health education messages, hospital announcements, and QR code between queue updates. Admin-configurable content via settings.

### 3. Position Circle Animation (from ScanQueue)

ScanQueue's large position circle with pulsing green animation when called is a delightful micro-interaction that clearly communicates "it's your turn" to patients.

> **Recommendation:** Add a pulsing animation to the "Called" state on the patient tracking page. Use a large circular indicator with the ticket number that pulses green when called.

### 4. Queue Delay Control (from ScanQueue)

ScanQueue's queue delay control lets staff add/remove 5-minute increments to all wait estimates — useful when a doctor is running late or called away.

> **Recommendation:** Add a "Delay Buffer" control on the staff dashboard that adds X minutes to all estimated wait times. Show the active delay as a badge on the dashboard.

### 5. Connection Status Indicator (from ScanQueue)

ScanQueue shows a Live/Synced/Connecting indicator on the dashboard so staff always know if real-time updates are working.

> **Recommendation:** Add a small connection status badge to the AppLayout header (green = connected, yellow = reconnecting, red = offline). WaitLess already has an offline indicator via the service worker — surface it more prominently.

### 6. Button-Based Service Selection (from Waitwhile)

Waitwhile replaced dropdowns with buttons for service selection, reducing clicks and cognitive load.

> **Recommendation:** Replace the department dropdown in registration and self-registration with a grid of clickable department cards (icon + name). More visual and faster to select.

### 7. Surface Editor for Display Boards (from Qmatic)

Qmatic's Surface Editor lets admins visually design kiosk and display board layouts — choosing what to show, where, and in what style.

> **Recommendation:** Add a display board configuration page in admin settings where admins can choose board layout (three-lane vs single-column), colors, font size, and content carousel items.

# 6. Final UI/UX Verdict

> **WaitLess ranks #1 for hospital UI/UX design (tied with Waitwhile for overall UX, but WaitLess wins for hospital-specific design)**
>
> WaitLess has the most visually polished and feature-rich UI of any hospital queue management system. Its use of modern web technologies (React 19, Tailwind CSS 4, Radix UI, Lottie animations, glassmorphism, dark mode, code-splitting) creates an experience that feels like a 2026 product — not a 2010s enterprise tool.

### Where WaitLess is the clear leader:

- **Visual polish:** Glassmorphism, gradients, Lottie animations, dark mode — no competitor has this
- **Patient-facing screens:** 5-stage tracking timeline, AI ETA, notification history, multi-language
- **Staff dashboard depth:** Priority color-coding, reassessment alerts, AI bottleneck alerts, Recharts
- **Clinical UI:** Triage assessment form with vitals, emergency indicators, pain scale — no competitor has this
- **Animation & micro-interactions:** LoadingPanel, AuthShell animations, Sonner toasts, hover effects
- **Mobile/PWA:** Service worker, offline caching, responsive design — only system with PWA
- **Multi-language:** English, chiShona, isiNdebele — only system with African languages

### Where WaitLess can learn from competitors:

- **From Waitwhile:** Drag-and-drop queue reordering, button-based selections
- **From ScanQueue:** Pulsing position circle, connection status indicator, queue delay control
- **From Qmatic:** Surface Editor for display board customization, content carousel for health education

### Competitor UI/UX rankings:

| Rank | System | Score | UI/UX summary |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 (tied) | **WaitLess** | ★★★★½ | Most polished hospital system. Modern stack, glassmorphism, animations, dark mode, PWA, multi-language. Best clinical UI. |
| 1 (tied) | **Waitwhile** | ★★★★½ | Best interaction design (drag-and-drop). G2 #1 easiest-to-use. But not hospital-grade — no clinical features. |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 3 | **ScanQueue** | ★★★★☆ | Clean, modern, mobile-first. Pulsing circle is delightful. But basic — no clinical depth, no analytics on dashboard. |
| 4 | **Qminder** | ★★★½☆ | Recently redesigned. Clean three-panel layout. Good counter staff UX. But no patient tracking page, no dark mode. |
| 5 | **Qmatic** | ★★★☆☆ | Enterprise/legacy feel. Surface Editor is unique. BI dashboard is powerful. But dated UI, no patient web UI, no modern design patterns. |
| 6 | **Wavetec** | ★★½☆☆ | Most dated UI. Feels like 2000s desktop software. Map view is nice. 50+ reports. But no modern web design, no patient UI, no mobile. |